

Jiahao Chen

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	expected May 2027
B.A. with Honors in Economics and Mathematics, University of Wisconsin–Madison	2019

Research Fields

Primary: Industrial Organization **Secondary:** Digital Economy, Economics of Innovation

Job Market Paper

Innovation Policy in Product-Line Markets: Evidence from GPUs [paper]

Summary. I study the effects of innovation policies in product-line markets, using a dynamic oligopoly model with endogenous pricing, product-line adjustment, and R&D. I apply the model to the desktop GPU market. I find that a dollar of R&D generates about \$9.0 of within-market surplus net of that dollar, with the firms capturing \$3.0 and consumers the rest. But the return to public support is far more modest. An R&D credit is the most effective instrument for frontier innovation, but it returns only \$0.51 of surplus per public dollar. The most welfare-improving policy among the policies studied is a consumer rebate on mass-market products, which returns \$1.09 per public dollar while inducing little additional R&D. A rebate on cutting-edge products backfires on innovation: it triggers a price war that transfers surplus from producers to consumers, undercutting the long-run incentive to innovate.

Work in Progress

Foundational Technology and Downstream Innovation: The Case of LLMs and Mobile Applications
Rhetoric, News, and Demand: How Information Style Shapes Consumer Behavior

Research Experience

Research Assistant, University of Chicago Booth School of Business	2019–2021
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Teaching Experience

<i>University of Michigan, undergraduate courses</i>	
Graduate Student Instructor, Matching and Market Design	2023, 2024, 2025
Graduate Student Instructor, Principles of Economics	Fall 2022

Fellowships and Awards

Rackham One-Term Fellowship	2026
Gerald C. and Theresa F. Timmis III Fellowship	2025
Graduate Research Award	2023, 2025
Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant	2024, 2025

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, R, MATLAB

References

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